



The Selectboard
TOWN OF WESTHAMPTON
TOWN HALL
1 SOUTH ROAD
WESTHAMPTON, MASSACHUSETTS 01027

Minutes of the Meeting
Monday, May 18, 2026, 7:00 PM
at the Town Hall, 1 South Road

Call to Order

The meeting was called to order at 7:01 PM.

PRESENT: Bronstein, Johndrow, Milikowsky

Public Comment on any item not on the agenda.

No public comment offered.

APPROVE and SIGN – Spruce Hill and Tob Hill Road – REVISED project agreements

Selectboard will review, vote to approve, and authorize chair to sign. Documents to be notarized.

The Board reviewed the proposed project agreements. The changes to the contracts were reviewed.

It was MOVED by Milikowsky, SECONDED by Johndrow

To approve the revised agreements and to sign.

VOTED: 3, 0, 0. (7:03 PM)

APPROVE and SIGN – Grant of Conservation Restriction

Board will review and sign

*a Grant of Conservation Restriction 18058 – **GRANTOR:** The Trustees of Reservations;*

***GRANTEE:** Kestrel Land Trust, Inc.; and*

*a Grant of Conservation Restriction 18059 - **GRANTOR:** Hilltown Land Trust, Inc.;*

***GRANTEE:** Kestrel Land Trust, Inc.*

pursuant to Section 32 of Chapter 184 of the Massachusetts General Laws. Votes to be taken.

The board reviewed the two Conservation Restrictions; it was noted that the town was not a party to either, and that approval was required by regulations.

Present: Lee Halasz, Kestral Land Trust

Mr. Halasz noted that two parcels were to be held by Hilltown Land Trust, but that Kestral Land Trust would hold the Conservation Restriction. No new obligation would be imposed on the Town. Public Access on both parcels would be permitted under the CR.

It was MOVED by Milikowsky, SECONDED by Johndrow

To approve CR-18058 and CR18059 and to sign.

VOTED: 3, 0, 0. (7:12 PM)

Kestral Land Trust will record, and will send

book and page to Mr. Finn for the Town's Records.

Reports of Departments

The Selectboard will receive and act on any reports or presentations from Department heads. Votes may be taken.

Mr. Finn noted approval by the Federal Government of a grant of \$883,000 from the Funding for Homeland Security, signed into law on April 30, 2026.

It was MOVED by Milikowsky, SECONDED by Johndrow

To form a needs assessment committee consisting of Chiefs, Wally, Todd, and a fifth member to be selected from members of the public.

VOTED: 3, 0, 0. (7:24 PM)

Chief Antosz also noted that the department had received a \$1,485.75 SAFE and \$2,072.04 Senior SAFE award from the FY26 Fire and Life Safety Education Grant program at the Executive Office of Public Safety and Security.

TO BE DONE – letter to Jim McGovern and Audrey Antosz thanking them for their work on the two grants.

Presentation on Consolidated Permitting for Renewable Energy Resources

Mr. Finn provided an overview of the recent changes to DOER regulations and the “consolidated permitting” procedures to be required by state regulations as of October 1, 2026.

Upon conclusion, Mr. Finn noted that there was still a significant number of unknowns in regard to the overall process, and how it might impact Westhampton. Mr. Finn recommended that the board NOT adopt consolidated permitting until the last possible minute – October 1, 2026. General concurrence by the board, but no formal action taken.

Board Deliberations

Discussion - Public Presentation on Property Assessment

Ms. Milikowsky noted that, previously, the Selectboard received a presentation from the Assessors about the assessment process. However, interactions with town residents relative to the Proposition 2-1/2 override made it clear that the town should plan some sort of presentation, open to the public, relative to real and personal property assessment, perhaps in September or early October.

Ms. Milikowsky suggested that we look for assistance from state or regional agencies on developing a public-friendly presentation.

Ms. Julia Lennon suggested a formal process which people could use to submit questions.

There was further discussion about regional inequities that affect rural communities more than urban or suburban communities.

The board generally agreed that the presentation would be of value to the town, and that the fall would be the best time to set up the presentation. Finding representatives from (perhaps) Division of Local Services or the Department of Revenue would be beneficial.

The board considered the technical challenges of making the recording available via live-streaming, or as a recording.

Mr. Finn was directed to contact assessors and assistant to inform them of the Board's intent, and to ask them to assist in planning the event.

Discussion – Town Messaging via Social Media

Ms. Milikowsky noted that, while the Selectboard has had conversations before, she recommended that the town develop its own page, allow comments, but not monitor or respond to them.

There was extensive discussion about the merits of posting on social media, the need to counter erroneous information being put out on social media, the potential benefits and detriments of the town creating its own “official” page on social media.

Ms. Lennon noted that it might be timely to reexamine how information is posted on the Town’s website.

There was extensive discussion about the specifics as to how social media might benefit the town, how much activity was too much, and what level of public relations was appropriate.

The board agreed to table the discussion to a later date. (8:08 PM)

Town Meeting – Recap and Update

Present: Mr. Ben Warren, Town Moderator.

Mr. Finn provided a summary of Town Meeting, and a preview of the continuance, scheduled for June 22. Mr. Warren noted that Town Counsel’s presence at the meeting was invaluable. He also noted that having staff ready to conduct a counted vote, or a secret ballot, was also a benefit.

Administrative Matters

Town Coordinator Update

No report.

Review and Act on any Correspondence

One piece of correspondence was presented. Mr. Johndrow requested that the board take the matter up in executive session.

Review and approval of minutes of past meetings

The minutes of May 4, 2026 were reviewed and amended.

It was MOVED by Milikowsky, SECONDED by Johndrow

To approve as amended.

VOTED: 3, 0, 0. (9:02 PM)

Review and approval of AP and Payroll Warrants (W26-23)

After review, it was MOVED by Milikowsky, SECONDED by Johndrow

To approve AP Warrant W26-23, and Payroll Warrants WP26-23

VOTED: 3, 0, 0. (9:05 PM)

Member Concerns

Board may discuss new topics raised by individual members, deliberate on potential action or future agenda placement, or give direction to staff.

No concerns raised by members.

Executive Session

It was MOVED by Johndrow, SECONDED by Milikowsky

To enter into executive session for the purposes of reviewing a letter from Mr. Orville Wright, and to discuss related matters about ongoing litigation.

VOTED: MILIKOWSKY: YES; JOHNDROW: YES; BRONSTEIN: YES.

The board entered executive session at 9:08 PM

ADJOURN

It was MOVED by Johndrow, SECONDED by Milikowsky

To exit executive session and thereafter to immediately adjourn

VOTED: MILIKOWSKY: YES; JOHNDROW: YES; BRONSTEIN: YES.

The board exited executive session at 9:15 PM, and immediately adjourned.

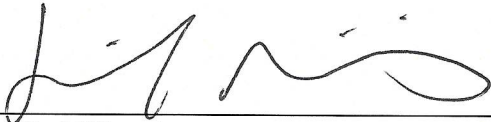
Approved by a vote of the Selectboard on June 1, 2026.



Susan Bronstein



Scott Johndrow



Jennifer Milikowsky